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STAFF MEMO

Date: December 19, 2024

To: Board of Education

From: Dan Jung, Chief Operating Officer

Subject: Bond Accountability Committee Membership

Background

The 2012 General Obligation Bond ballot measure and explanatory statement language was referred to the Multnomah Elections Division on August 21, 2012. The measure's summary statement identified the requirement for PPS to provide citizen accountability and oversight. With the passage of the 2012 Capital Construction Bond, staff developed a Bond Accountability Committee (BAC) charter with Board input to address this requirement. As noted in the charter, BAC consists of approximately 7 - 10 individuals with a good reputation in the community for fairness and transparency and people with a combination of experience in building design; construction; construction financing; public contracting, budgeting and/or auditing.

The terms of three current BAC members—Cara Turano, Jonathan Trutt, and Ryan Kinsella—are set to expire at the close of 2024. Throughout their tenure, each has been an exceptionally engaged and impactful contributor, offering invaluable expertise, thoughtful feedback, and sound judgment to further the BAC's mission. In light of their significant contributions, staff recommends reappointing Cara, Jonathan, and Ryan for additional four-year terms.

In addition to the expiring terms, the BAC also has several vacancies. In September, PPS initiated a public recruitment process to fill these open positions. After engaging with several highly qualified candidates, the Office of School Modernization recommends the following individuals for appointment to the Bond Accountability Committee:

Annie Kwon

Annie is a registered architect based in Portland, with experience working locally as well as with a prestigious global design firm headquartered in New York City. She currently teaches architectural design at the University of Oregon's Portland satellite campus and serves on the Executive Committee of the AIA Oregon Urban Design Panel. In addition to her professional accomplishments, Annie is also a PPS parent.

Jessica Dunham

Jessica is a seasoned capital project manager for the City of Portland, bringing over 20 years of expertise in design and construction. Her experience spans overseeing a wide range of construction projects, including expansions and modifications. Jessica has a deep understanding of public procurement processes and has built strong relationships

with MWESB/COBID-certified vendors. Jessica is also a PPS parent.

Chris Dunning

Chris is a certified public accountant with extensive experience in Portland and internationally. As Deputy Chief Financial Officer at the Bonneville Power Administration, Chris played a key role in financial planning and accounting for the capital program, which neared $1 billion annually. In his current role as Chief Financial Officer at Energy Trust of Oregon, Chris leads accounting, financial compliance, and financial planning processes, engaging in significant discussions and negotiations with stakeholders, including the Oregon Public Utility Commission. Chris has served on the Cleveland High School Modernization Comprehensive Planning Committee and is currently involved in the Cleveland High School Modernization Design Advisory Group. Chris is a PPS parent.

Travis George

Travis currently serves as the Director of Capital Finance at the Port of Portland, overseeing the management of its substantial debt portfolio, including all aspects of its bond program. Recently, he led the financing for the new terminal expansion at PDX, a project that involved issuing approximately $1.7 billion in bonds. Before joining the Port, Travis was the Debt Manager at the East Bay Municipal Utility District, a major public water and wastewater utility in the Bay Area, where he managed the District's bond program and capital budgeting. In addition to his role at East Bay, Travis chaired the San Francisco Public Utility Commission's Revenue Bond Oversight Committee, a citizen oversight group similar to the BAC, and served as a member of the City of Oakland's Budget Oversight Committee. Earlier in his career, Travis worked as an Analyst at Moody's Investors Service, where he spent five years assigning bond ratings to a variety of local governments across the western U.S., including numerous school districts in Oregon and other states. Travis is also a PPS parent.

With the above appointments, the BAC membership will reach a total of nine, leaving room for additional members. Staff will continue to actively recruit potential candidates and encourage Board members to refer any prospective applicants to staff for consideration.

Staff Recommendation

Staff recommends the appointment of Annie Kwon, Jessica Dunham, Chris Dunning, Travis George Jonathan Trutt, and Ryan Kinsella to the committee for the following term durations:[1]

- Annie Kwon, 3 years
- Jessica Dunham, 3 years
- Chris Dunning, 2 years
- Travis George, 2 years
- Jonathan Trutt, 4 years
- Ryan Kinsella, 4 years
- Cara Turano, 4 years

Resources

- Bond Accountability Committee Charter: https://www.pps.net/Page/464

[1] Committee memberships are staggered to allow for an overlap of terms